NEIGHBOURWISE AI

Neighborhood Intelligence Report

Jamaica Plain

Boston, Massachusetts

70.2

out of 100

▲ Strength: **Schools**

▼ Weakness: **Universities**

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Nestled in the heart of Boston, Massachusetts, Jamaica Plain is a vibrant and diverse neighborhood that effortlessly blends urban living with a touch of suburban tranquility. With a master score of 70.2 out of 100, it's our top pick for those seeking a balanced lifestyle. The area is particularly renowned for its exceptional schools, scoring an impressive 94.3, making it an ideal choice for families. However, the lack of universities in the immediate vicinity, its lowest score at 0.0, suggests that it may not be the first choice for college students seeking a campus-centric environment.

Jamaica Plain's unique character is further defined by its excellent transit system, scoring a high 92.0, which makes commuting a breeze, whether you're heading to downtown Boston or exploring other neighborhoods. The area also boasts ample grocery options and quality healthcare facilities, scoring 83.9 and 82.0 respectively, ensuring your daily needs and well-being are well catered to. However, the neighborhood's safety score of 58.9 suggests that while it's generally safe, potential residents should be aware of typical city precautions.

The neighborhood's housing market, scoring 59.6, offers a range of options from historic homes to modern apartments, appealing to a mix of young professionals and families alike. The abundance of Bluebikes, scoring 88.5, adds to the neighborhood's charm, promoting an active lifestyle and offering an eco-friendly transportation alternative. However, with a restaurant score of 52.5, Jamaica Plain may not be a gastronomic hub, presenting a trade-off for foodies seeking a wide variety of dining options. Despite this, Jamaica Plain's overall appeal lies in its balance of urban conveniences and community charm, making it a standout choice for those seeking a neighborhood that truly feels like home.

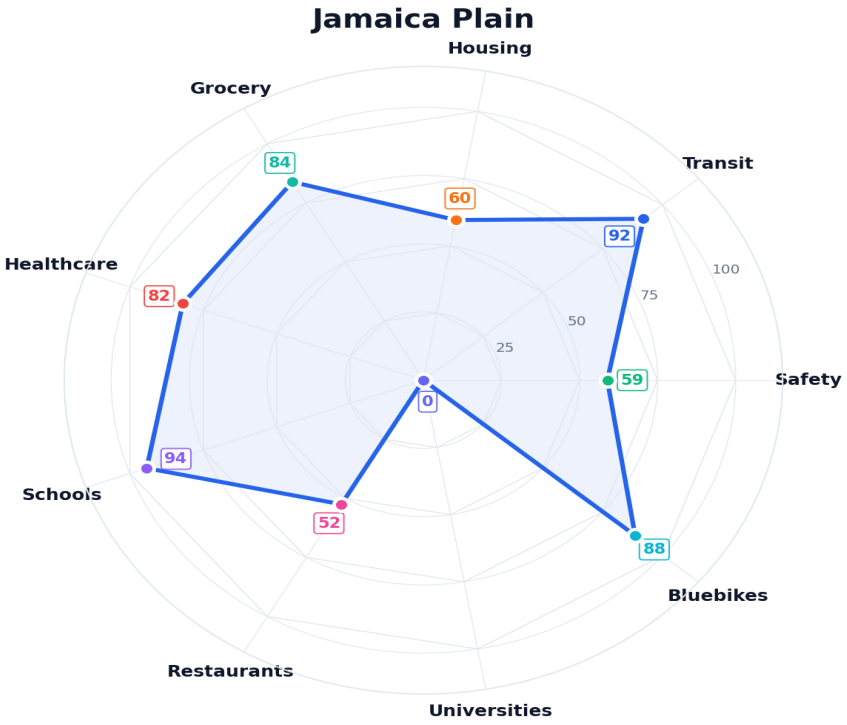
DOMAIN SCORECARD

DOMAIN	SCORE	GRADE
Safety	58.9	Good
Transit	92.0	Excellent
Housing	59.6	Average
Grocery	83.9	Abundant
Healthcare	82.0	Excellent
Schools	94.3	Excellent
Restaurants	52.5	Good

Universities	0.0	None
Bluebikes	88.5	Excellent

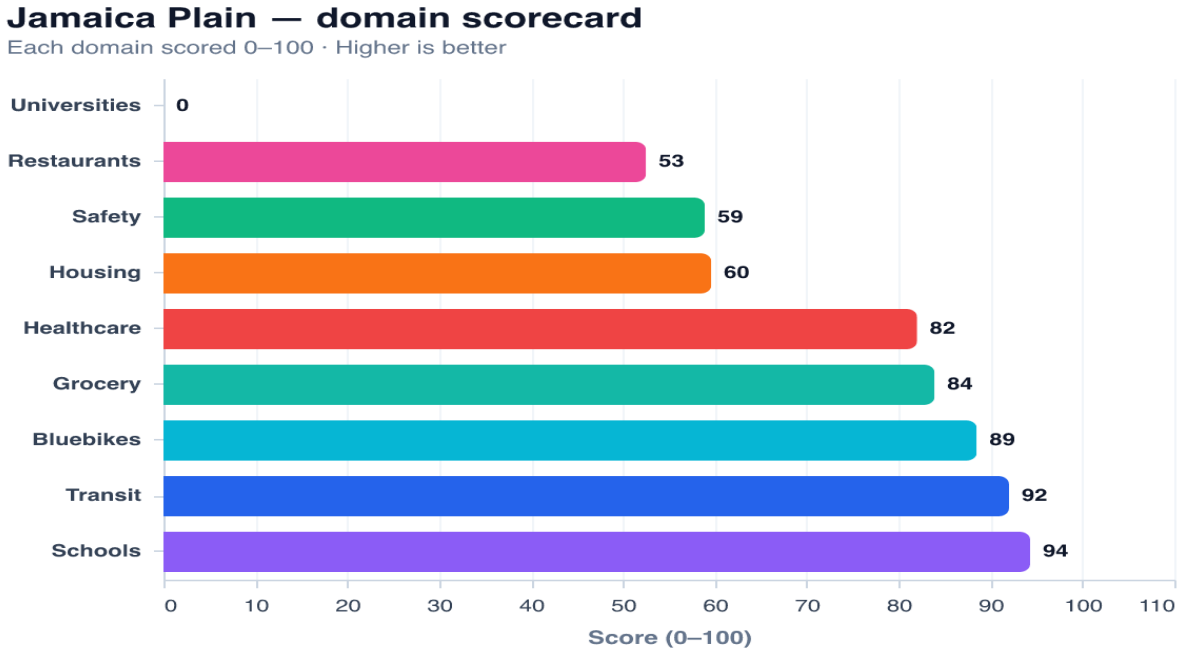
VISUAL ANALYSIS

Domain Radar



Each spoke represents one of the 9 scored domains (0–100).

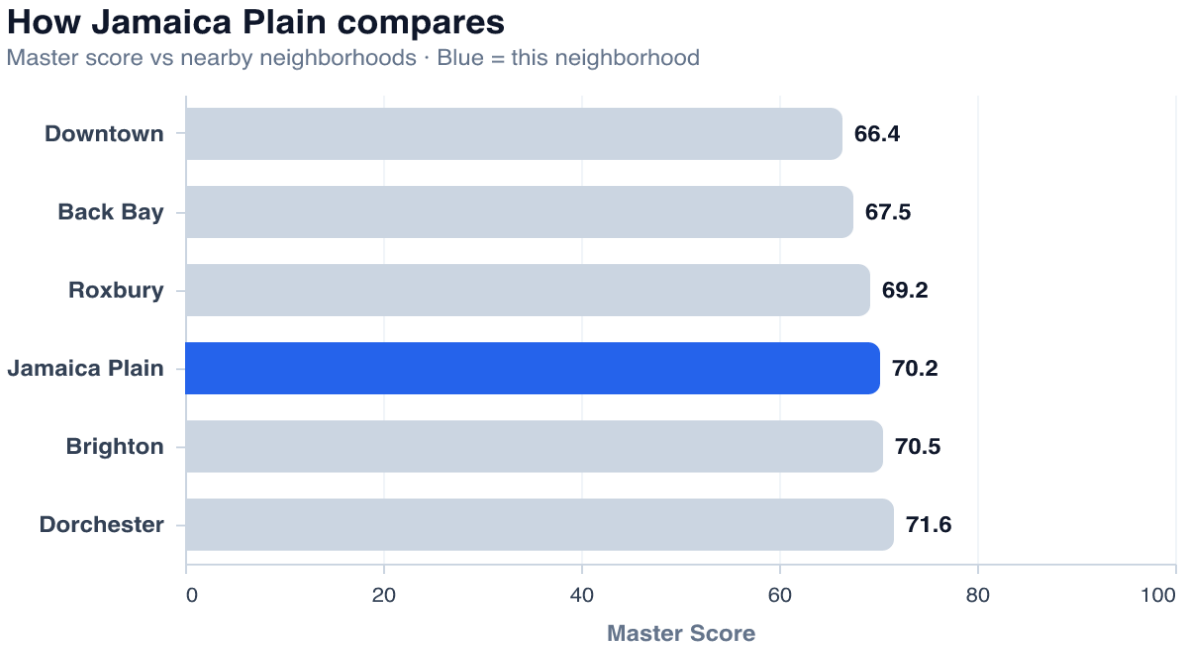
All Domain Scores



Color-coded by domain · Higher = stronger performance.

COMPARISON & TRENDS

Neighborhood Comparison



Blue bar = this neighborhood · vs 5 nearest by master score.

Crime Trend & Forecast

Blue = actual · Orange dashed = SARIMAX forecast + CI band.

Trend: Increasing · Model MAPE: 8.5% · Reliability: HIGH

In Jamaica Plain, Boston/Cambridge, recent crime trends show a slight increase, with an average of 383 monthly crimes compared to 360 in the same period last year. By 2026-04, the forecast suggests a minor decrease to approximately 380 crimes per month. Notably, 73.8% of crimes occur within 32 identified high-density clusters, indicating that safety measures could be effectively focused in these areas.

DOMAIN ANALYSIS

Safety

In Jamaica Plain, a neighborhood within Boston, Massachusetts, the safety score is a commendable 58.9 out of 100, despite a high density of incidents at 3639.85 per square mile. The most prevalent type of incident is non-criminal, specifically "Sick Assist" calls. However, when considering actual crimes, property crimes are the most common, accounting for 17.20% of all incidents. There's been a slight increase of 5.18% in incidents year over year, indicating a need for continued vigilance.

Transit

Jamaica Plain, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, boasts an excellent transit score of 92.0, making it a commuter's paradise. It is served by two rapid transit routes, the Green Line E and the Orange Line, with key stops including Forest Hills Station and Jackson Square Station. The area is also well-connected by a multitude of bus routes, with 95 total stops, 92 of which are bus stops. Notably, 94.7% of these stops are wheelchair accessible, ensuring inclusivity for all commuters. Major destinations include Back Bay, Ruggles Station, and Mattapan Station, with connections to the Franklin/Foxboro Line and Needham Line.

Restaurants

Jamaica Plain, a vibrant neighborhood nestled within Boston, Massachusetts, offers a good restaurant scene with a diversity of cuisines, earning an average rating of 3.76 out of 5. With a density of 109.39 restaurants per square mile, diners can choose from 431 establishments, spanning five distinct culinary categories. The area boasts a healthy mix of 209 budget, 200 mid-range, and 22 upscale eateries, with 43.2% classified as high quality. Delightfully, delivery is available from approximately 73.3% of these dining options.

Universities

No universities or colleges are located in JAMAICA PLAIN, BOSTON. Residents seeking higher education would need to travel to nearby neighborhoods.

LIFESTYLE & CHARACTER

Jamaica Plain, a vibrant neighborhood in Boston, Massachusetts, is a melting pot of cultures with a unique blend of urban and suburban vibes. The neighborhood's character is shaped by its diverse population, with a significant presence of Black and Latinx communities. However, the area faces notable disparities in public transportation services. Unlike the predominantly White neighborhoods such as Back Bay, Beacon Hill, and Fenway, which enjoy the convenience of rapid transit services, Jamaica Plain, much like Dorchester, Mattapan, and Roxbury, relies heavily on bus services. This reliance often results in longer commute times, despite the neighborhood's proximity to downtown Boston, due to the lack of rapid transit options and the inconsistency of bus services.

Daily life in Jamaica Plain is a testament to resilience and community spirit. The neighborhood's public housing residents, many of whom are Latinx, often express frustrations about unequal transit services, with buses frequently filled to capacity upon arrival. This issue is further compounded for persons with disabilities, who face challenges with non-functioning elevators and escalators, and inadequate services from the MBTA's RIDE and ridesharing services. Yet, the community remains vibrant and engaged, advocating for better services and equity. The neighborhood's spirit is best encapsulated in its ongoing struggle for fair housing and equity, as reported in the Metropolitan Boston's Fair Housing and Equity Assessment. Despite these challenges, Jamaica Plain's rich cultural diversity and strong community spirit make it a unique and appealing place to live.

WHO SHOULD LIVE HERE?

1. The neighborhood of Jamaica Plain in Boston, Massachusetts, is most suitable for families. This is primarily due to the high score in the 'Schools' category (94.3), indicating excellent educational institutions, and the decent 'Safety' score (58.9), which suggests a relatively secure environment for children.

2. Students might want to look elsewhere as the 'Universities' score is 0.0, indicating a lack of higher education institutions in the immediate vicinity. Additionally, the 'Housing' score is relatively low (59.6), which could imply limited affordable housing options for students.